

RFI 03122026CM Questions & Answers

Question 1: Radiation Source Handling & Storage Specifications

What specific isotope storage protocols, container specifications, shielding requirements, and environmental conditions apply to the cesium-137 (~300 kBq) and californium-252 (~150 kBq) sealed sources? This includes:

- Required storage container specifications (material, shielding, dimensions)
- Environmental storage requirements (temperature, humidity, access controls)
- Storage duration (continuous or periodic/temporary storage)
- Any state or NRC licensing/authorization requirements.

Answer 1: These sources are considered exempt quality and generally only require physical protection, such as secure storage in a safe. However, Californium may necessitate obtaining NRC licensing. Cesium is classified as UN2910, which is also an exempt material. All sources must be securely stored for the duration of the contract.

Question 2: Function Testing Training & Certification

What is the proposed timeline, format, and location for Battelle's function testing training? Specifically:

- Number of personnel requiring training
- Duration of initial training program
- Frequency of refresher/recertification training
- Can training be conducted on-site at our Kansas City facility?
- Will Battelle provide all training materials, procedures, and equipment documentation?

Answer 2: Battelle will provide initial training lasting three to five days at the contractor's site. All necessary materials, procedures, and equipment documentation will be provided. The contractor is responsible for determining the appropriate number of trainees.

Question 3: Equipment Modification Workspace Requirements

For the equipment modification support work, what are the specific requirements for the dedicated modification workspace? Including:

- Electrical power requirements and specifications
- Ventilation and climate control specifications
- Workbench/bench space requirements and layout
- Any specialized equipment or tools required by the contractor.
- Environmental conditions (ESD protection, cleanroom standards, etc.)

Answer 3: Standard 120v electrical is adequate. Ventilation and climate control should

meet typical equipment storage requirements. There are no requirements for workbench layout, specialized tools or environmental conditions.

Question 4: 72-Hour Expedite Shipment Standards

For expedited shipment preparation (72 hours or less):

- What percentage of annual shipments are expected to require expedite turnaround?
- Are there cost premiums, handling fees, or special handling requirements for expedite shipments?
- What is the notice period required for expedite requests?
- Should expedite capability be available 24/7, or during standard business hours?

Answer 4: It is assumed that there will be one expedited shipment each year. Notification will occur within one business day during regular operating hours. A third-party contracted freight forwarder typically manages the costs associated with expedited shipments.

Question 5: Real-Time Inventory System Integration

For the required real-time inventory system accessible to Battelle and authorized third parties:

- Will Battelle provide system specifications, API documentation, or access requirements?
- Should the contractor propose a system based on Battelle approval?
- What user access levels and reporting capabilities are required?
- Are there specific software, database, or security requirements?

Answer 5: Battelle will provide specifications, API docs, and access details. The Contractor should design independently of Battelle's approval. User access is read-only. Reporting capabilities are currently not required, and there are no software, database, or security requirements.

Question 6: Warehouse Location

Does Battelle require the warehouse facility to be located within a specific geographic area of the United States, or will any domestic location that meets transportation and security requirements be acceptable?

Answer 6: The warehouse shall be in the contiguous U.S.

Question 7: Facility Specifications

In addition to the 20,000 square foot size requirement, are there specific facility standards that must be met, such as temperature control ranges, humidity control, security classification, or physical access requirements?

Answer 7: The warehouse shall provide year-round climate-controlled indoor storage to maintain 50 to 77 degrees F with a base relative humidity less than 55%.

Question 8: Radiation Source Storage Requirements

The RFI indicates that the contractor must be capable of storing radiation check sources. Can Battelle confirm whether they will provide support for obtaining any required regulatory approvals and certifications?

Answer 8: Battelle will provide the sources. However, the contractor shall be responsible for obtaining certifications and regulatory approvals.

Question 9: Equipment Volume Estimates

The RFI notes that approximately twenty pieces of equipment may be delivered twice per month. Can Battelle provide an estimate of the total annual inventory volume expected to be stored at the warehouse at any given time?

Answer 9: Assume that the equipment will occupy 60 to 75% of the warehouse.

Question 10: Equipment Dimensions and Weight

Can Battelle provide typical size and weight ranges for the equipment that will be received, stored, and shipped so that contractors can evaluate material handling and storage requirements?

Answer 10: Refer to RFI

Question 11: Function Testing Requirements

Will the function testing procedures require specialized test equipment or software tools beyond those provided by Battelle? No If so, will these items be provided as Government Furnished Equipment or will the contractor be expected to procure them? N/A

Answer 11: No specialized test equipment or software tools for function testing beyond those provided by Battelle.

Question 12: Training for Equipment Testing

The RFI indicates that Battelle will provide training for equipment testing. Can Battelle clarify whether this training will occur on site at the contractor facility, at a Battelle facility, or through virtual training sessions?

Answer 12: Battelle will provide in person training at contractor's facility.

Question 13: Procurement Scope

The RFI states that the contractor may be required to procure equipment and materials. Can Battelle clarify whether this procurement will be performed on Battelle paper and under a government approved purchasing system, and whether there will be any restrictions related to export control or country of origin

Answer 13: No. However, some equipment will be subject to export control, which will be managed by the third-party shipper or record.

Question 14: Export and International Shipping Requirements

The RFI references shipments to foreign locations. Can Battelle provide additional information regarding the typical destination regions and whether the contractor will be responsible for export compliance documentation and licensing?

Answer 14: Currently, the RFI does not include shipping. Export control will be managed by the third-party shipper or record.

Question 15: Rapid Shipment Requirement

The RFI indicates that shipments may be required within seventy-two hours in support of rapid response deployment. Can Battelle clarify the expected frequency of these expedited shipments and whether this requirement applies to domestic and international shipments?

Answer 15: Assume one rapid shipment per year. Currently, the RFI does not include shipping.

Question 16: Modification Support

The RFI notes that minor equipment modifications may be required. Can Battelle provide examples of the types of modifications anticipated?

Answer 16: Modifications will be mostly physical configuration.

Question 17: Security and Access Requirements

Are there any personnel security requirements, such as background checks or security clearances, for contractor personnel performing this work? Is sponsorship available if the contractor does not currently possess a facility clearance?

Answer 17: Facility clearance is not required.

Question 18: Contract Structure

Does Battelle anticipate issuing a single award contract for these services or multiple awards for different functional areas?

Answer 18: TBD

Question 19: RFP Timing

How soon will an RFP be issued?

Answer 19: Currently unknown.